Gmail **Stephen Cooke <stephencooke.c@gmail.com>**

Re: Frozen Bank Account - Stephen COOKE - NSW 2278/25/9

2 messages

EAInbox <EAInbox@afsa.gov.au> Mon, Nov 2, 2026 at 2:10 PM
To: "stephencooke.c@gmail.com" <stephencooke.c@gmail.com>
Cc: Quoc DO <Quoc.Do@afsa.gov.au>

OFFICIAL

Dear Sir,

I refer to your recent enquiry to Johnston and the AFSA Service Centre . Generally, funds held in a bank account at the date of bankruptcy vest in the trustee. We will review the information on file and contact the relevant banks if further enquiries are required.

Your file has now been assigned to Case Officer Quoc Do. he will be in touch if any additional information or documentation is required.

Kind regards,

Ly Bui

Acting Case Manager | Estate Administration

Trustee Operations, Personal Securities and Regulatory Programs

Australian Financial Security Authority
T 03 8631 4924 | **E** ly.bui@afsa.gov.au | **W** www.afsa.gov.au

OFFICIAL

From: stephencooke.c@gmail.com

Sent: Monday, November 2, 2026 12:38 PM

To: Johnson.Baquiran@afsa.gov.au

Cc: info@afsa.gov.au

Subject: Re: Bankrupt Estate of Stephen COOKE - NSW 2278/25/9

OFFICIAL

Hi Johnson,

Thank you for forwarding my enquiry to the relevant team and confirming that my bankruptcy estate has been finalised.

I appreciate your assistance. However, I urgently need clarification and action regarding the funds held in my Commonwealth Bank account when my bankruptcy commenced, totalling $8,504.47.

Both Commonwealth Bank and Westpac have advised me that they require communication or written instructions from AFSA before they can remove the bankruptcy-related restrictions and restore my banking access.

Could you please urgently confirm:

1. Whether AFSA has any remaining claim over the funds held in my Commonwealth Bank account at the commencement of bankruptcy.
2. Whether the finalisation of the estate means those funds can now be released to me.
3. Whether AFSA can issue written confirmation or formal instructions directly to Commonwealth Bank and Westpac confirming that the relevant restrictions can be lifted and my access restored.
4. Whether copies of any such correspondence can also be provided to me so I can present them to the banks if necessary.

I also need to emphasise the urgency of this situation. I have returned to Australia and am currently trying to rebuild my financial stability following bankruptcy. Without access to my banking facilities and these funds, I am facing the very real possibility of having nowhere to sleep tonight.

I am not simply seeking clarification for administrative purposes. Access to these funds is now critical to securing immediate accommodation and meeting basic living necessities.

Given that the estate has been finalised, I would sincerely appreciate this matter being escalated and addressed as a matter of urgency, ideally today.

Thank you again for your assistance. I look forward to hearing from you as soon as possible.

Kind regards,

Stephen Cooke Bankruptcy reference: NSW 2278/25/9 Email: stephencooke.c@gmail.com

OFFICIAL

Important: If you have received this transmission in error please notify us immediately by return email and delete all copies. If this email or any attachments have been sent to you in error, that error does not constitute waiver of any confidentiality, privilege or copyright in respect of information in the email or attachments.

Stephen Cooke <stephencooke.c@gmail.com> Mon, Nov 2, 2026 at 2:39 PM
To: EAInbox <EAInbox@afsa.gov.au>
Cc: Quoc DO <Quoc.Do@afsa.gov.au>

Dear Ly,

Thank you for your response and for confirming that my file has been assigned to Case Officer Quoc Do.

I appreciate that funds held in bank accounts at the commencement of bankruptcy generally vest in the trustee. However, I am seeking clarification of the specific status and disposition of the funds in my circumstances.

As previously advised, the balance in my Commonwealth Bank account at the commencement of bankruptcy was AUD $8,504.47.

I understand from Johnson Baquiran's earlier correspondence that my bankruptcy estate has been finalised. Could you please clarify how this finalisation affects the funds held in my account?

In particular, I urgently need confirmation of:

1. Whether the $8,504.47 was claimed, realised or otherwise dealt with by the trustee.
2. Whether AFSA currently retains any claim or interest in those funds.
3. Whether the funds can now be released to me.
4. Whether AFSA can issue written instructions directly to Commonwealth Bank and Westpac to remove the bankruptcy-related restrictions on my accounts.
5. If AFSA considers that the funds cannot be released, the specific reason and what steps are available to resolve the matter.

I also wish to reiterate that I am currently experiencing serious financial hardship. I have no accessible funds and am struggling to secure basic accommodation and necessities.

This is not simply an administrative inconvenience. The continued inability to access banking facilities is directly affecting my ability to support myself and rebuild my financial stability.

Given that the estate has been confirmed as finalised, I would be extremely grateful if Case Officer Quoc Do could review this matter as a priority and provide a clear written response.

Thank you for your assistance.

Kind regards,

Stephen Cooke Bankruptcy reference: NSW 2278/25/9 stephencooke.c@gmail.com

[Quoted text hidden]